

Phase 1 Formal Credentials & Network Establishment

2026 – 2027

BG-01 — Complete the SMU Executive MBA with Distinction

AO-01 Complete Term 3 maintaining GPA on track for distinction. Target: 2026

- **IN-01** STRA-6231 Strategic Management for Executives Summer 2026
Done when: Course completed; grade consistent with distinction trajectory.
- **IN-02** BA-6230 Managing Operations for Executives Summer 2026
Done when: Course completed; grade consistent with distinction trajectory.
- **IN-03** BA-6210 Global Business Project Summer 2026
Done when: Project delivered; grade consistent with distinction trajectory.

AO-02 Complete Term 4 maintaining GPA on track for distinction. Target: H2 2026

- **IN-01 – IN-04** Term 4 electives (4 courses, selections pending advisor confirmation) H2 2026
Done when: All four courses completed; grades consistent with distinction trajectory.

AO-03 Complete Term 5 and graduate with distinction. Target: H1 2027

- **IN-01 – IN-04** Term 5 electives (4 courses, selections pending enrollment) H1 2027
Done when: All four courses completed; EMBA degree conferred with distinction.

BG-02 — Establish a Credible Professional Narrative and Targeted Network

AO-01 Complete LinkedIn profile and resume rewrite for corporate strategy positioning. Target: 2026

- **IN-01** LinkedIn profile rewrite Summer 2026
Done when: Profile reflects strategy-oriented positioning; headline, summary, and experience rewritten.
- **IN-02** Resume rewrite Summer 2026
Done when: Resume reflects director-targeted positioning; two-page format; accomplishment language in place.

AO-02 Build a targeted network in corporate strategy at large A&D primes. Target: 2027

- **IN-01** External network development 2026 – 2027
Done when: Minimum five substantive relationships initiated with strategy professionals at target organizations.
- **IN-02** LinkedIn content and professional visibility 2026 – 2027
Done when: Consistent content cadence established; profile activity visible to target audience.

AO-03 Establish internal visibility at Collins and identify an executive sponsor. Target: 2027

- **IN-01** Build executive visibility within Collins 2026 – 2027
Done when: At least two senior leaders above current management chain contacts aware of work and trajectory.
- **IN-02** Secure executive sponsorship 2026 – 2027
Done when: One senior leader has agreed to provide periodic guidance and advocacy; quarterly touchpoint cadence established.

BG-03 — Transition into a Strategy-Adjacent Role at Collins

AO-01 Expand current role scope to include strategy-adjacent activities.

Target: 2026 – 2027

- **IN-01** Sustain and document workforce utilization performance 2026
Done when: Billable utilization at or above target for all three teams through end of 2026; performance narrative with revenue impact framing prepared.
- **IN-02** Pursue strategy-adjacent activities within current role 2026 – 2027
Done when: At least one initiative with visibility above current management chain completed; participation in BD, capture, or strategic planning activity documented.
- **IN-03** Position for and pursue a strategy-adjacent role or scope expansion H2 2026 – 2027
Done when: Active pursuit of at least one strategy-adjacent role or formal scope expansion within Collins initiated.

Gate 1 Condition: EMBA complete; professional narrative and digital presence established; internal visibility initiated; executive sponsor identified.

Phase 2 Positioning & Role Transition

2027 – 2029

BG-03 — Transition into a Strategy-Adjacent Role at Collins

AO-02 Secure a strategy-adjacent role or formal corporate strategy function within Collins at Senior Manager level or above. Target: 2027 – 2028

- **IN-01** Target and pursue corporate strategy role within Collins 2027 – 2028
Done when: Strategy-adjacent role at Senior Manager level or above secured within Collins.
- **IN-02** Develop financial modeling depth 2027 – 2029
Done when: Financial modeling capability sufficient to contribute credibly to strategic analysis; EMBA coursework and self-directed study applied.

Gate 2 Condition: Strategy-adjacent role secured at Senior Manager level or above within Collins.

Phase 3 Visible Performance in Strategy Role

2029 – 2030

Initiative detail for this phase is directional. Full elaboration occurs at the Phase 2 annual review once Gate 2 is cleared.

BG-04 — Own at Least One Consequential Strategic Work Product Informing an Executive Decision

AO-01 Deliver a strategic work product that directly informs a senior executive decision. Target: defined at Gate 2

- **IN-01** Deliver executive-level strategic work product 2029 – 2030
Done when: At least one strategic deliverable completed where the output is traceable to a consequential executive decision.

Gate 3 Condition: At least one consequential strategic work product with traceable executive decision completed; M&A adjacent exposure initiated.

Phase 4 Evolve Skillset & Future Optionality

2030 – 2031

Initiative detail for this phase is directional. Full elaboration occurs at the Phase 3 annual review once Gate 3 is cleared.

BG-05 — Positioned Credibly for a Corporate Development Role with M&A Exposure

AO-01 Establish the credentials and positioning required to compete credibly for a corporate development role at a large A&D prime. Target: defined at Gate 3

- **IN-01** M&A adjacent exposure and financial modeling depth 2030 – 2031
Done when: Meaningful M&A adjacent experience accumulated; financial modeling depth sufficient to compete as a serious candidate.
- **IN-02** Assess CVC and external optionality 2030 – 2031
Done when: Corporate venture capital and external market options assessed; positioning toward highest-value path confirmed or revised.

Gate 4 Condition: Credibly positioned for a corporate development role at a large A&D prime; CVC optionality assessed.